

Get tuned with Google Ears

Music aficionados have all the reason to be on a high. The neat new feature of Jelly Bean, called Google Ears, which is basically a sound search, listens to music playing in your surroundings and tells you what you're listening to. This Jelly Bean update can be used on all ICS devices and ROMs.

Google Ears will not only listen to a song for you, but also bring up the artist, album and a direct link to the Google Play Store so that you can buy it. It seems to work just as quickly as other music listening services such as SoundHound and Shazam, the Android community reports.

Google Ears does not offer any history or previous tags like its competing apps do, but the direct one click link to the Play Store to buy the song is quite interesting. Also, anyone with an ICS device or ICS ROM can avail the Google Ears services.

Adaptxt beta version 1.0 for Android tabs

KeyPoint Technologies, a pioneer in developing innovative user-interface products that target a wide range of mobile and connected platforms, has announced the launch of Adaptxt beta version 1.0 for Android Tablets. Powered by Predictive Text 2.0, it is designed to learn and adapt to the writing styles of users, and allows them to write more with minimal keystrokes. It provides highly accurate and relevant text prediction, error-correction and auto-correction inputs by combining the best of artificial intelligence and computing technology.

Users can now choose between split and standard keyboard layouts; the Adaptxt keyboard for tablets has a new 'ergonomically' designed keyboard layout, which makes typing with two hands a breeze. The repositionable suggestion bar has been specifically designed for heads-up and heads-down users and can be adjusted according to the user's preference.



Android on Moto Razr and Maxx!

For all the Android lovers, here is a piece of good news. Motorola Razr and Maxx owners will soon be able to upgrade their devices to the latest version of Google's Android operating system, the manufacturer announced.

Android 4.0, known as Ice Cream Sandwich, offers improvements to the way the platform works and this announcement follows international trends.

Some have raised concerns that the latest version of the operating system may not work on under-powered devices and, in Japan, mobile operator NTT DoCoMo announced that it was halting the Ice Cream Sandwich update for Xperia devices.

New features on Ice Cream Sandwich include an improved contacts app that includes bigger images and the ability to take screen shots and send them to friends. Some of the features are available on the Samsung Galaxy SIII,

Mageia Linux gets popular

Mageia Linux, the not so known distro, is now in the No. 4 spot for rankings over the past six months, behind only Mint, Ubuntu, and Fedora, claim sources.



It's not uncommon for individual distributions to shift up and down slightly on the list over time. Still, this is quite a big jump. Long time Linux fans will remember that Mageia is a fork of Mandriva Linux that was launched in late 2010. Whereas its beleaguered French parent is a commercially run distribution—now at No. 27 on DistroWatch—the Mageia project is community-based and non-profit. Released this May, Mageia 2 is the latest stable version of the free and open source operating system, and it offers a number of compelling features.

Most interesting, in fact, is the plethora of desktop environments Mageia users can choose from. Not only does Mageia 2 include KDE 4.8.2, GNOME 3.4.1 and Xfce 4.9 as desktop options, it packs three others as well: LXDE, E17 and the lightweight Razor-qt 0.4.1.

Mageia's look has also been updated in this second release of the software for "a smoother appearance regardless of desktop," the project team says.

Among the many power-packed applications that come along with it are the new GIMP 2.8, LibreOffice 3.5, Digikam and Showfoto 2.6 photo-management systems, the VLC 2.0.1 media player, Amarok 2.5, Flash Player Plugin 11.2, Chromium Browser 18, and the business-oriented Extended Support Release of Firefox 10.